

BEST Course in summer

SURVIVAL GUIDE

The Alchemy of Startup Creation:

Turn Your Idea into Gold!

08.08-15.08.2026.



CONTENTS

SERBIA

Greetings and toast the serbian way.....	5
Serbian cuisine.....	6
Traditional drinks.....	7
Country of sport.....	9

BELGRADE

Belgrade Top 10	12
University of Belgrade.....	14
Monetary, prices and weather.....	15
The language.....	16
What to bring ?.....	17
How to get to Belgrade?.....	18
BEST Belgrade.....	20

WHAT ARE BEST Courses?

BEST (Board of European Students of Technology) is an international, non-profit, apolitical and non-governmental student volunteer organization. Since its founding in 1989, BEST has brought together **more than 5 000 students of STEM faculties across Europe** to gain experience and knowledge through various projects and seminars.

LBG Belgrade was founded in November 2003 by enthusiastic students with the same goal which is to support young people on their career path. This year in August, we are organizing a BEST Course in Summer!



BEST Courses

In these events, participants attend lectures given by the university's teaching staff or by experts from companies. At the end of the course students take an exam, which is designed to evaluate the participants' success.



SERBIA



Serbia is a country situated at the **crossroads of Central and Southeast Europe**, located in the heart of the **Balkan Peninsula**, where a vast majority of its 7 million citizens are Serbs, and the rest belong to any of the 40 different national communities. Being a country of **hospitable, emotional, and joyful people**, who possess a sense of sportsmanship, extraordinary traditions, and a huge cultural heritage that enriches the entire European culture, Serbia is one of those marks on a map of the world you need to discover and **experience at least once in a lifetime**. Serbia has always straddled between the East and West, not only in a geographical sense, but political and cultural as well.

Serbia's the place where **some of the world's greatest minds were born** and where they matured into people whose work has significantly changed the world. Everybody's heard about Serbian scientist **Nikola Tesla** - "**the father of electricity**", and some equally notable scientists were **Milutin Milanković**, the creator of the world's most accurate calendar and **Mihajlo Pupin**, a Serbian scientist who has participated in founding of **NASA**.

Serbia is also known for its brilliant poets and artists, such as **Ivo Andrić**, **Emir Kusturica**, **Nadežda Petrović**, etc.

GREETINGS AND TOAST THE SERBIAN WAY

Shaking hands , typically **using the right hand** is common in Serbia when being introduced to or meeting someone of either gender. When greeting someone you have just met, people usually exchange a **friendly verbal greeting and maintain eye contact**, which are considered polite and respectful. Greeting a friend or a colleague is often accompanied by a warm hug.

In Serbia, toasts are usually made with **traditional rakija** (brandy), often home-distilled. Toasts are made by clinkin glasses, making direct eye contact and loudly proclaiming **Živeli! (Cheers)**.



SERBIAN CUISINE

TYPICAL BREAKFAST

Breakfast in Serbia is an early, but a rich meal.

Breakfast is usually accompanied by coffee, tea, milk and yoghurt. Pastries or bread are served with butter, jam, sour cream and cheese, accompanied by bacon, salami, kajmak, eggs and ajvar. There is also a great variety in pastries: pogačice, kiflice, pletenice, zemičke... The star of the show is definitely burek.



ROŠTILJ (famous serbian barbecue)

- ★ **Pljeskavica** (Hamburger)
- ★ **Ćevapčići** (ground meat sticks)
- ★ **Vešalica** (grilled strips of pork loin)
- ★ **Mešano meso** (various sausages, mixed grill)
- ★ **Ražnjići** (Skewers)
- ★ **Leskovački roštilj** (Leskovac grills)



NATIONAL DISHES

The main dish is always a meat dish.

Main dishes which are not grilled include: **Pečenje**, **Roasted meat** (whole roasted pork, lamb and goat), **Karađorđeva šnicla** (breaded rolled steak stuffed with kajmak and occasionally sliced ham and cheese), **Musaka** (Moussaka, made with aubergines/eggplant, potatoes or zucchini in combination with meat), **Podvarak** (stewed sauerkraut, usually with meat and bacon pieces), **Prebranac** (baked beans in sauce), **Sarma** (stuffed cabbage rolls), **Svadbarski kupus** (Wedding cabbage, cabbage cooked with smoked pork).

TRADITIONAL DRINKS

Non-alcoholic

High quality and abundance of fruit, along with plentiful water resources, result in the production of **high-quality fruit juices and mineral waters**, which are among Serbia's most widely known exports.

There are, however, few domestic carbonated soft drinks. One interesting traditional soft drink **made from corn**, which is now less commonly consumed, is **boza**. **Kvass** is also produced by some breweries.

Coffee in Serbia is **not just a drink - it is a whole ritual**. Many people start their day with a large cup of strong black coffee. Serbian black coffee is not the same as in most of Europe and is quite different from American black coffee. It originated from Turkey, so the **expression "Turkish coffee" is still used**; however, there is a difference in preparation and serving, and it is often **referred to as local coffee (domaća kafa)**.

Tea is far less popular, with mostly herbal teas being consumed, either on their own or as supplementary medicine.

Among dairy products, **yogurt is common**, as are kefir and similar varieties.

The famous Serbian **mineral water Knjaz Miloš** is considered a national brand and can be consumed with any meal. However, among Serbian youth, it is more commonly used as a remedy for **hangovers**.



TRADITIONAL DRINKS

Alcoholic

VINJAK

Vinjak is a brand of **brandy** produced by the **Serbian company Rubin**. The drink itself is light brown, and contains 40% alcohol. Rubin, a company created in 1955. and privatised in 2005, has produced the drink since 1957. The spirit is **produced by wine distillation**, resulting in a 67–70% alcohol-by-volume concentration. It is then **aged several months to several years**, depending on quality range, in oak casks of 500 liters each.



RAKIJA

Of distilled beverages, the most popular are various fruit brandies called rakija. Many people in Serbia brew their own rakija and it is famous for being smooth but very alcoholic and it is said that one cannot get a hangover from it. Serbian rakija is very difficult to find elsewhere in the world though. Various kinds of rakija are named after fruit they are made of, among the most known ones are:

- * **Šljivovica** (plum brandy) - National drink
- * **Dunjevača** (quince brandy)
- * **Viljamovka / Kruškovac** (pear brandy)
- * **Jabukovača** (apple brandy)
- * **Malinovača** (raspberry brandy)
- * **Lozovača** (grape brandy)
- * **Pelinkovac** (a wormwood liqueur, like Jager drink)
- * **Medovača** (honey brandy)
- * **Klekovača** (made from a plant called Kleka sometimes used for stomach pain)

BEER

Beer is also widely enjoyed in Serbia. There are about 40 breweries and two large festivals devoted to beer, which are Belgrade Beer Fest and Beer Days in Zrenjanin. Some of the most popular beers are: **Zaječarsko, Jelen, Lav**, and many craft beers that are manufactured exclusively in Serbia.



COUNTRY OF SPORT



Sport plays a huge part in Serbian culture. Some of the most popular sports in Serbia are **basketball, water polo, volleyball, tennis and football.**

Novak Đoković is probably the most famous Serbian athlete. Đoković has won **24 Grand Slam singles titles** and numerous awards, such as **Laureus World sportsman** of the year five times.

Our **water polo team** is the third most successful team in the history of sport, having **won an Olympic gold medal in 2016, 2020 and 2024**, three World championships, 12 FINA World Leagues and 7 European championships.

Ivana Španović is the world champion in long jump and the most successful athlete in the history of Serbian athletics. She won **gold at the 2023 World Athletics Championships**, is a multiple-time European and World indoor champion, and claimed European outdoor gold in 2016. She is also an **Olympic bronze medalist from Rio 2016.**

COUNTRY OF SPORT



Serbia has **won 5 Olympic medals at the Olympic games in Paris Olympic 2024.** Novak Đoković (tennis), Zorana Arunović and Damir Mikec (shooting) and waterpolo team won gold medals. While, Aleksandra Perišić has won silver and our basketball team bronze medal.



Serbia is one of the traditional **powerhouses of world basketball.** The Serbia men's national basketball team has won **two World Championships**, three European Championships, one FIBA Diamond Ball, two Olympic silver medals and one bronze.

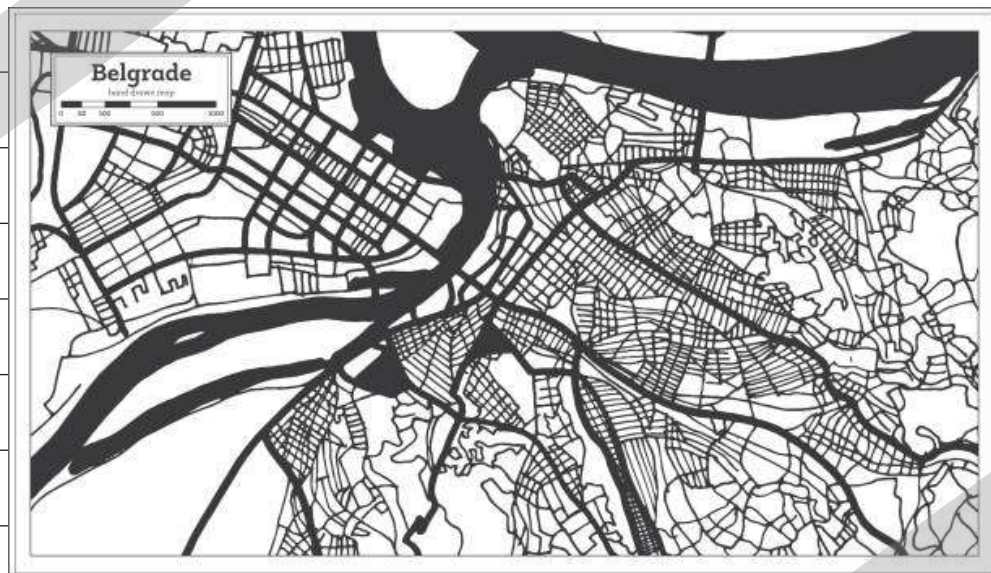


Our basketball players are very successful and famous worldwide: **Vlade Divac, Peđa Stojaković, Nikola Jokić** (three-time NBA MVP), **Bogdan Bogdanović, Nemanja Bjelić**, etc. Serbia is considered **“The Land of Basketball”**.

BELGRADE

Belgrade is one of the **oldest cities in Europe**. This “**white city**” is the only capital built at the confluence of two big rivers - the Danube and the Sava. Belgrade's population is about 1.7 million people. It is an administrative, political and cultural center of the country and the Balkans.

The **city never stops growing**, and when it crossed the Sava River, it became “new”. **New Belgrade** (Novi Beograd) is the Serbia's business center. Belgrade is also known as the city that never sleeps and is a symbol of **great nightlife**. **Floating clubs** on its rivers Sava and Danube have become symbols of great parties and never-ending fun, and **Skadarlija**, the bohemian street, is well known as the place where music and singing can be heard until dawn.



TOP 10



Feel the spirit of the past and discover the secrets behind the walls of the Belgrade Fortress. Visit the Roman Well, a bunker from the Cold War and many more mysterious and hidden underground places. Enjoy the view of the confluence of the rivers and a walk through Kalemegdan park and the city center - Knez Mihailova street, National Museum and Republic square.

Let yourself be impressed with the beauty and size of Saint Sava Temple, the biggest Orthodox temple in the Balkans. Take a walk through one of the most beautiful Belgrade neighbourhoods.



Participate in interactive exhibitions in the Museum of aviation, Historical museum, museum of chocolate or Nikola Tesla Museum, and see some excellent experiments there.



Get a firsthand experience of the Serbian tradition in Skadarlija, a small bohemian quarter. Make some great memories in this old, cobblestone, picturesque street. Discover what kafana is and try delicious traditional dishes and much popular Rakija.



Relax on the beach of Ada Ciganlija - the sea of Belgrade. Rent a bike or roller skates and make a tour around the lake or just lie on the beach and soak up the sunbeams.

TOP 10



Belgrade Waterfront is a vibrant riverside district on the Savski kej, blending modern architecture, culture, dining, and nightlife with stunning views of the Sava River. It offers a unique mix of urban energy and relaxed riverfront atmosphere.

Dočol holds a special place in the heart of Belgrade. It is one of the oldest parts of Belgrade with a specific kind of energy where old meets new. It is also a neighborhood where you can find numerous galleries, bars, cafes and restaurants.



Go along the River Danube and visit the old town of Zemun. Enjoy an amazing view of Belgrade from the top of tower and try out delicious fish specialties in one of the restaurants by the river.

Find out why Belgrade is “the city that never sleeps”. Visit some newborn party districts or simply go to the world-famous floating river clubs during summer.



Visit the Royal Palace and find out interesting details about Belgrade as a capital of the Kingdom of Yugoslavia. On the other hand, visit the Museum of Yugoslav History where you can learn a lot about communist era in Yugoslavia.



UNIVERSITY OF BELGRADE

The University of Belgrade is a **state university**. Its main activities in the fields of higher education and scientific research are of public interest, and they are carried out in accordance with the applicable legal regulations.

The University of Belgrade celebrates September 13 as its day. This is the date when lessons started at the first Higher School, founded by **Dositej Obradović**.

During the **two centuries** of its existence, the University of Belgrade has served the people of Serbia, and its former students and teachers have greatly contributed to the development of cultural, scientific, educational, political and economic life of our country.

The University of Belgrade is prepared to maintain and enhance its position as the leading institution of higher education in the region by adapting to the challenges of modern times on one hand, and preserving what is valuable in its tradition on the other. This is precisely what makes it recognized as a **true national brand**.



MONETARY, PRICES AND WEATHER

Currency: DINAR (RSD)

At the time we were writing this document, exchange rates were:

1 € ~ 117.39

1 \$ ~ 100.84



PRODUCT	PRICE(RSD)
Water	50 - 100
Beer (0.5l can)	70 - 150
Beer (in a cafe)	300 - 600
Wine	300 - 700
Pljeskavica (hamburger)	350 - 600
Pizza slice	350 - 500
Burek (pie)	300 - 450
Cigarettes	400 - 550
Condoms	300 - 500
Coffe	250- 500

CLIMATE

Belgrade has a continental climate, with cold winters reaching around 5°C and hot summers, when temperatures last year reached up to 40°C. Spring and autumn are especially pleasant, with temperatures ranging between 15°C and 25°C.

July is one of the hottest months, with an average temperature of 24.3°C (76°F), while August is the warmest overall, averaging 23.8°C. January is the coldest month, with an average minimum temperature of 0.8°C (33°F).

TYPE OF TRANSPORT	PRICE
Zone 1 and 2	Free*
Zone 1, 2 and 3	Free*
Night transport	Free*
"E" bus lines	200**
A1 (Airport)	400**

* There are no tickets to purchase

** Tickets purchased from the bus driver

THE LANGUAGE

ENGLISH

SERBIAN

Hello / Hi

Zdravo / Ćao

Yes / No / Maybe

Da / Ne /Možda

Thank you

Hvala

Good morning / afternoon / evening

Dobro jutro / dan / več

My name is ...

Moje ime je ...

Nice to meet you

Drago mi je što smo se upoznali

See you tomorrow

Vidimo se sutra

How are you?

Kako si?

0,1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8,9,10,100,1000

Nula,jedan,dva,tri,četiri,pet,šest,sedam, osam, devet, deset, sto, hiljadu

What time is it?

Koliko je sati?

How much is it?

Koliko košta?

Wine / Beer / Water

Vino / Pivo / Voda

Coffe / Milk / Tee

Kafa / Mleko / Čaj

I don't speak Serbian

Ne govorim srpski

I don't understand

Ne razumem

Where's the toilet?

Gde je toalet?

Exchange office

Menjačnica

Train / Bus / Taxi

Voz / Autobus / Taksi

Cheers!

Živeli

He/She is boring

Koji smarač

You are so hot!

Baš si zgodna/zgodan! *female/male

What is that?

Šta je to?

Excuse me, can you help me, I need to get to Zdravko Celara 14, but since I am a foreigner, I got a little lost, if you could call this number:

Izvinite, možete li mi pomoći, treba da dodem do Zdravka Čelara 14, međutim pošto sam stranac malo sam se izgubio, ako biste mogli da pozovete ovaj broj:

+381 66 338777

+381 66 338777

WHAT TO BRING?



Most important YOURSELF!



Passport and visa (if you need one)



Plane/Bus/Train ticket



ID card (optional)



International Student Identity Card (ISIC)



Travel/Health Insurance



Medicine



Pocket money for extra expenses



Towel and hygiene stuff



Comfortable clothes and shoes



Formal clothes for opening and closing ceremony



Stuff for international evening (traditional drink, food, flag)



Songs from your country



Survival Guide



BEST spirit

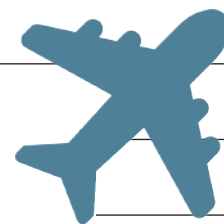
HOW TO GET TO BELGRADE?

BY PLANE

Airport Belgrade "Nikola Tesla"

Official website of the airport: <https://beg.aero/eng>

Information phone number: **+381 11 209 4444**



There are three ways to come from the Airport to the city center:

1. Public transport

Option 1 – Bus 72

- City bus No. 72 operates from 4:50 a.m. to 11:30 p.m., departing every 35 minutes.

The bus departs from the stop in front of the Departure Gate.

- Get off at Zeleni Venac, the final stop on this line.
- From there, take bus 16, 95, 27E, or 35 and ride to "Centar za kulturu Vlada Divljan".
- From this stop, the dormitory is within walking distance.

Option 2 – Bus 600

- City bus No. 600 operates from 4:30 a.m. to 11:55 p.m., departing every 30 minutes.
- Get off at the "Sajam" bus stop and transfer to bus No. 23.
- Ride bus 23 to "Hala Aleksandar Nikolić", which is the closest stop to the dormitory.

2. Shuttle bus A1

You also have a **shuttle bus from airport** to the Slavija square, and if you use this bus it will be **a lot easier for us to pick you up** and you'll arrive much **quicker**. You can find the timetable for this bus at this link

<https://shorturl.at/DnO8w>

This bus cost **400 RSD (3.42 EUR)**

Note: Sat = Hour, Radni dan = Work day, Subota = Saturday, Nedelja = Sunday

3. Taxi transportation

Honestly, we **strongly advise you against this option**, as the taxi drivers in Belgrade **like to charge way too much** (around 25€, 3000 RSD), especially foreigners. If you go for the taxi, please contact the city service TAXI INFO, located in the baggage claim area at Nikola Tesla Airport and please do not forget to take the taxi receipt at the airport Info Desk, specifying the desired destination and the price for taxi service. This way you will make sure the taxi service is in line with the most favorable rate.

HOW TO GET TO BELGRADE?

BY BUS

Belgrade Bus Station is the only bus station in Belgrade and it is located in the "Novi Beograd".

Website:

<http://www.bas.rs/en/information-and-ticket-booking/>

Address:

Antifašističke borbe 2, Belgrade

Phone:

+381 11 2636 299; +381 11 2627 146

Working hours:

from 07:00 to 20:00 on business days, from 07:00 to 16:00 on weekends.
You can find more useful information about bus lines to Belgrade on this website:

<https://www.eurolines.de/en/home/>



Belgrade is often referred to as the crossroad of Europe. The network of international roads E-75 and E-70 connects Belgrade to all of the neighboring capital cities.

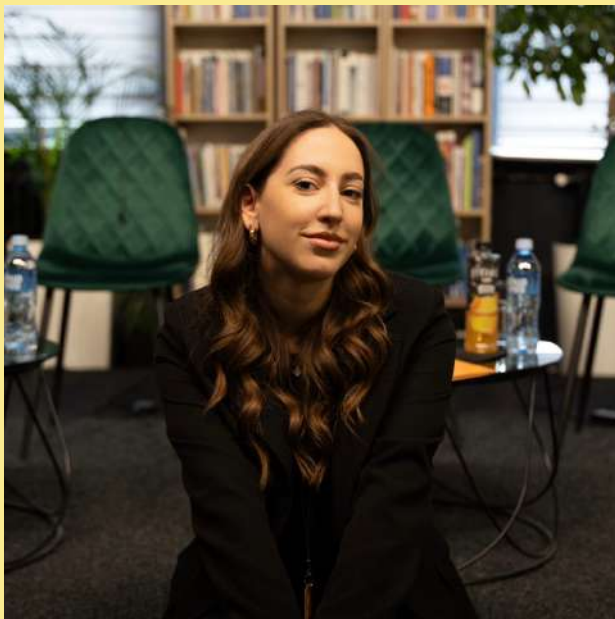
Map of toll stations in Serbia:

<https://www.putevi-srbije.rs/index.php/en/mapa-naplatnih-stanica-novo-2>

BEST Belgrade

is a local group of BEST that has more than **250 members** coming from numerous STEM faculties of the University of Belgrade. Since it was founded in 2003, LBG Belgrade has become one of the **largest** and most recognizable **student organizations** in Serbia.

If you have any questions or suggestions, do not hesitate to contact us **we are available 24/7!**



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